

Radical Rest is...

1

Having hard conversations with people I love dearly because I'm trying to shift my energy from surviving to living. From having my fight, flight, or freeze activated more often than not to intentionally experiencing the fullness of presence.

2

Practicing presence by taking a series of snapshots in my mind of all of the specific details of the moment that make it enjoyable. I take in a deep breath to ground myself in the real world through smell and touch—the way the air feels going past my nose—and say a quick prayer of gratitude.

3

Rejecting any label that others have assigned to me along with any attempts to punish me for that thing that I am not.

4

Choosing to release myself from the impulse to over analyze any negative situation to the point of having to prove to myself that I'm justified in feeling hurt or wronged or disrespected. Feelings may not be facts but they also don't need to be proven to be true to be worthy.

5

Refusing to compromise on designated me time. And it's appreciating the fact that I can create designated me time—not everyone can—but also not feeling guilty about having that flexibility. My flexibility doesn't create or impede anyone else's flexibility or lack thereof. And this me time is semi-structured to be physically, emotionally, spiritually, and mentally restorative.

6

Choosing to disengage so I can feel my feelings and then get to processing my thoughts instead of stuffing things down in the name of not losing someone. A person who loves me will give me the time I need and join me in approaching the resulting discussion in figuring out what went wrong and how to get the train back on the track.

7

Integrating little treats into chores, and taking active breaks between tasks. Like burning incense to fold clothes but making a cocktail and getting really high before moving on to meal prepping. And then eat one of the servings before moving on to changing the kitty litter.

8

Finding ways to make the mundane luxurious. Like using a lavender shower bomb whenever I get the urge, doing my makeup and hair at a vanity instead of in the bathroom mirror, and listening to cafe jazz while I'm reading.

9

Telling my cat why I'm angry while petting him so I can get it out and move on to something that helps me shift the energy while he does his part by purring.

10

Meditating on the people who see my humanity instead of a creature that must be contained when I start feeling frustrated about the people who shoot me down, critique me, or debate me when I'm gently sharing observations about our interactions that bother me. I'm so grateful for the people in my life who listen and acknowledge my pain even when I'm actively pretending or deluding myself into believing I'm indifferent.

11

Becoming so comfortable with myself that I feel less and less inclined to mask for fear of judgement.

12

Keeping a little bit of my fire for myself. Turns out fear doesn't thrive in the light.

13

Exploring new modes of restoration. Take what resonates and leave the rest.

14

Staying flexible on the details but grounded in the purpose. Sometimes the original way I conceived of something needs to be de-complicated and boiled down to its essence. I can't always go above and beyond, but my basic effort has been and will always be above average.

15

Surviving the wilderness of isolation and becoming satisfied with embodying truth.

16

Soaking up matrilineal energy to ground deeper in my power. I talk to my father's side a lot but there is something magical about my mom's side. It feels completely different yet deeply natural. I don't really fit in but it doesn't matter because these are my people.

17

Exploring new ways to be creative and not allowing my disinterest in drawing to block me from canvas-based visual mediums.

18

Finding inspiration in Black women who lived multiple lives before I was ever conceived of. They've been doing this before it the cycle restarted. Learn from their lessons.

19

Clocking when a negative times a negative equals a positive and overstimulation needs the final boss of ultimate stimulation (like shocking my system with a horror film or crashing out). That's probably a time to pull out a grounding tool (like a group meditation or nature walk).

20

Stopping the impulse to save other people. Everyone has their own journey and I inhibit their ability to learn and grow if I rescue them from their trials. My own resources start drying up when I step into others' healing lanes and they begin to flow when I stay in my lane.